About The Author



Percival Wilde (1887 – 1953) was an American author and playwright. He wrote novels, short stories and one-act plays. He also authored a textbook on the theatre arts. Native to New York City, Wilde graduated from Columbia University in 1906, and worked for a time as a banker. He began writing plays in 1912. Wilde's plays were especially popular in the Little Theatre Movement.

Percival Wilde chose to portray the values of life in his plays, throwing light on a specific trait of an individual. His one-act play *The Hour of Truth* is a testimony to his craftsmanship where the three classical unities of time, place and action are observed. The climax of the play develops rapidly and ends with a pleasant surprise.

Glossary

wrecking	-	ruining, destroying (here, bankruptcy)
indict	-	accuse or charge someone for a crime and put on trial
testify	-	give evidence as a witness in court
governor	-	the way John addresses his father
go on the stand	-	testify during a trial in the court of law
smash-up	-	complete collapse (insolvency)
indignantly	-	angrily
perjure	-	swear falsely
haggle	-	argue, disagree
reckoned	-	calculated
misappropriate	-	to take other's money dishonestly for one's own use
nonplussed	-	confused, puzzled
baptized	-	named, christened
of his own accord	-	voluntarily, without compulsion
technicality	-	a minor detail
shams	-	people who cheat others
hypocrites	-	people who put on a false appearance, pretenders
apprehension	-	fear
buoyantly	-	cheerfully
piteously	-	sympathetically

1. Rearrange the following sentences in a meaningful sequence and write the summary of the play.

a) Baldwin who returned home after meeting Gresham, informed his family that Gresham had offered a hundred thousand, if he would utter the words 'I don't remember' in court, during the trial.

b) The family members tried to justify Gresham's act and enticed Baldwin into accepting the money.

c) Thus 'The Hour of Truth' had dawned relieving Baldwin of the heavy burden and guilt.

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